

Process Overview Visualization (Group Work Only)

Name	Preferred Contact Method	Role	Shadow Role
Noah Figueiredo	Instagram	Primary: Design Lead and Project Coordinator Shadow: Development Support	Shadow: Technical Integration

Tabish Nazary	Instagram	Primary: Experience and Systems Designer	Shadow: Technical Integration
Daniel Chen	Instagram	Primary: Research and Ethical Framing Lead	Shadow: Gameplay Support
Hoy	Instagram	Primary: Gameplay Systems Developer	Shadow: Research Alignment
Jayden Ribeiro	Instagram	Primary: Technical Lead	Shadow: Experience Review

Timeline

Early Stage: Concept & Research

Primarily Noah & Tabish's,

- Focus on understanding epilepsy and what the experience entails for it.
- Define core game mechanics
- Understanding what epilepsy research is and figuring out how we can incorporate into a proper game
- Brainstorming proper game mechanics that relate to the concept of the game we have in mind
- Gameplay ideas that help to make the game more interesting
- Setup the coding aspects (Jayden, Hoy, Daniel) so that things are setup to start coding

Decision Points:

1. Stress Bar
2. Maze Timer

Mid Development Stage: Coding & Testing*Everyone*

- Worked with Claude to lay out the basic foundation of our game (original game mechanics and visuals)
- Tested the game to ensure each mechanic works as described
- Removed any mechanics we believed wouldn't work or broke rules (removed flashing lights during episode state as this is a seizure inducing effect)
- Tested every output given to us by Claude to ensure there would be no broken code

After Showcase Feedback:

- Implemented new mechanics we believed would be of benefit to our game
 - Added time boosts to lower the difficulty level of our game as winning was very RNG based before showcase
 - Added a zoom out mechanic for players to see more of the maze and find new paths to win at the cost of higher stress (trade off mechanic to make gameplay more interesting)

Pivots:

- Shifted our focus to make the game more beginner friendly (our testers Tabish and Hoy are avid gamers and found the game easier than new players would)
 - Added time boosts
 - Added Z (zoom out feature)

Final Week: Refinement*Everyone*

- Implement new changes to the code to make the game better.
- Presented the project to the class to get feedback on what to improve on for the next assignment

Decisions:

1. Make the game look more aesthetic and make it have texture and characters that match the artistic style
2. Make the game simpler because it's too challenging for random people to play the game.
3. Think about making levels for the game.

A1 – A3 (Group Work)

Decision 1: Decide our core mechanic

- Add a stress bar, when full, reverses the controls of the player
- As the stress bar increases, the radius you can see around the map would decrease
- This was to represent the loss of control/sensory challenges that people with epilepsy disorders face
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 2: Task of the Game that Amplifies our mechanic for our disorder

- Created a randomly generated maze for the game with three playable characters and a timer that if you don't reach the end will kill you and end the game.
- We chose this because we felt it would amplify the aspects of confusion, sensory challenges, and unpredictability.
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 3: Added safe zones and red zones to influence our mechanic

- Added zones where it amplifies or decays the stress bar
- We felt as though this would add more ways to manage the stress bar resource, so our players wouldn't feel completely helpless with the stress bar going up
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 4: Added sprint mechanics

- An increased speed button that increases the stress bar progress, but grants you increased speed
- This was added to add another layer of skill that players can play off of. It not only adds complexity to it, but makes the game easier by speeding up the game flow
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 5: Added Sound Effects

- Added basic sound effects like when the stress bar ramps up and when you pick up stuff
- We added sound effects to indicate to the player that their stress bar changed or the timer changed.
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

After the play test, we incorporated suggestions from TAs and other groups to reduce the game's difficulty.

Decision 6: Added blue balls that increase the overall time meter

- Added blue balls around the maze that increase the timer by 5 seconds.
- Due to complaints by the other groups and suggestions from our TA we realized the game was too hard. So we decided on a skill-based way to decrease the difficulty by adding time to the timer
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 7: Added in-game sprites

- Added in-game sprites to the walls and added character animations based on the mood we thought the game had.
- The team decided the game would be dark and spooky.
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 8: Added a map function where you zoom out to see the thing

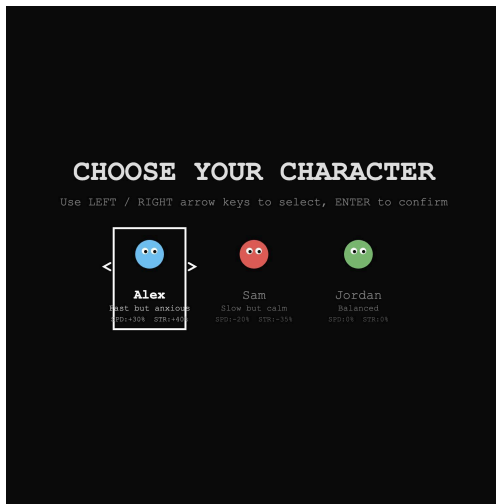
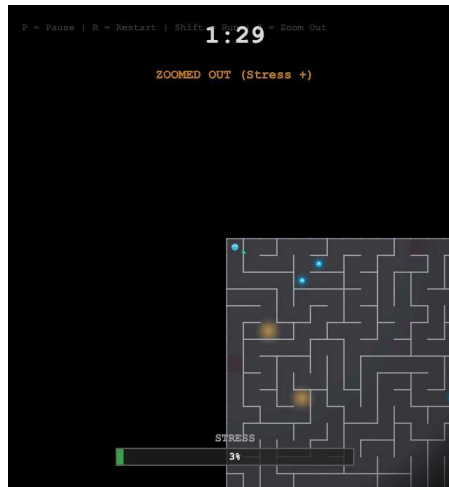
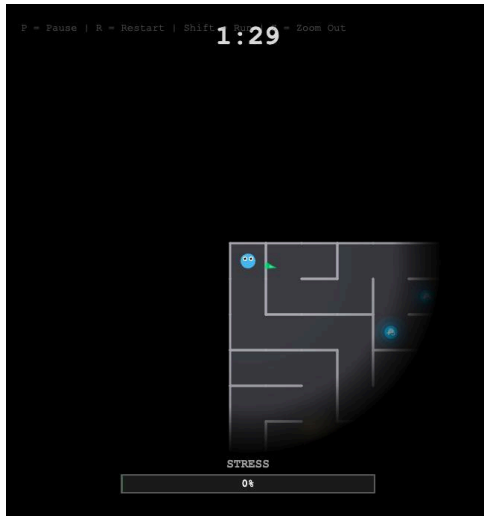
- Added a map function where when you zoom out your stress bar increases.
- We decided on that because our TA said that since we can't see the ending of the map, the map would be used to quickly note down a path
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

Decision 9: Added a way to find the final destination

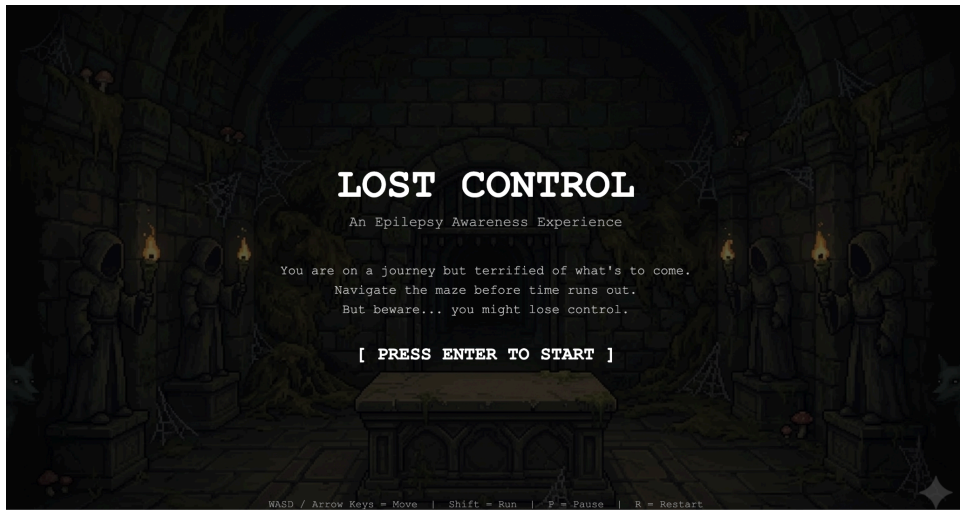
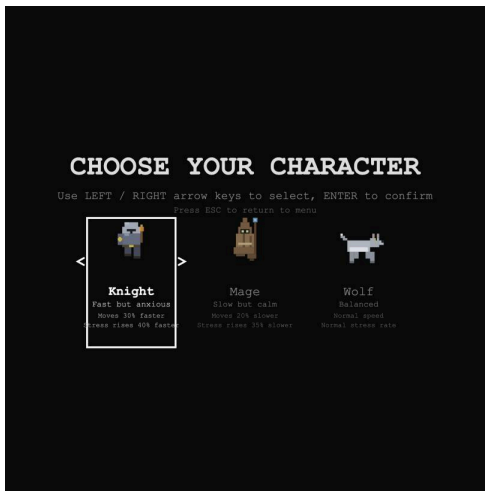
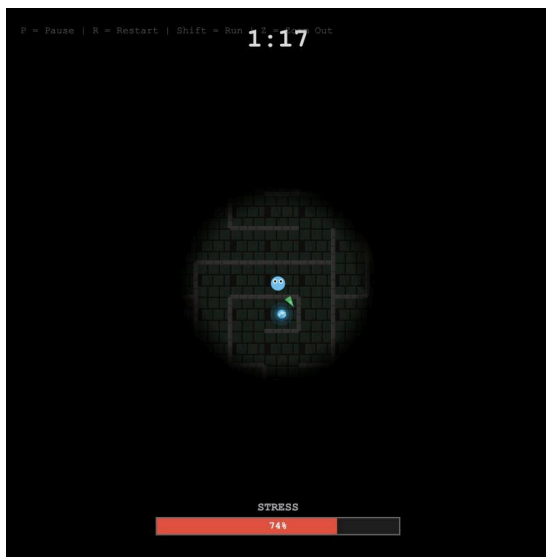
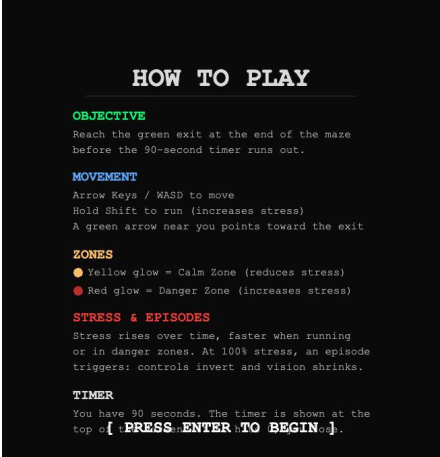
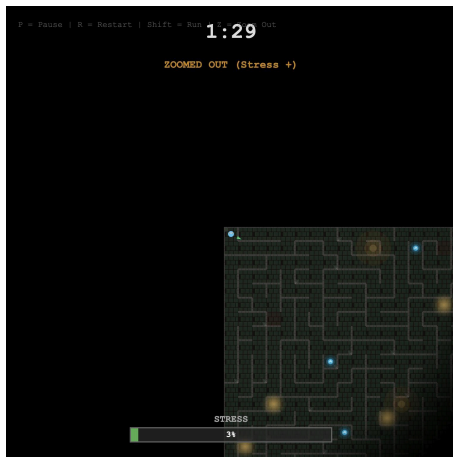
- Added a green arrow from the player that leads the player to a set final destination
- We decided on that because there was no way to find the ending of the maze
- Tabish and Noah worked on this decision
- Hoy, Daniel, and Jayden made this decision a reality

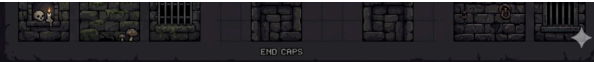
Role-Based Process Evidence

BEFORE:

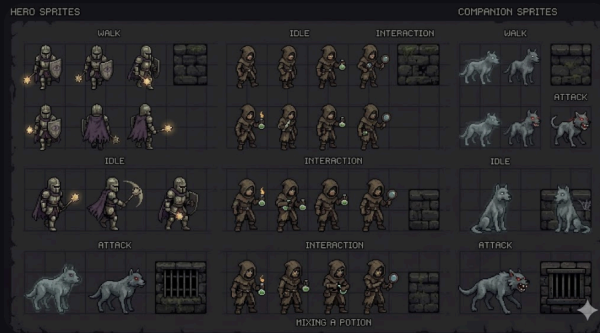


AFTER:





generate me 3 characters that would be moving in this maze



- Confused
 - Did not know what to do
 - **Make the controls larger**
 - **Doesn't know the actual objective of game**
 - Does not know what yellow and red are
 - Make the commands larger text
 - **Make the default circle a little bigger, the scale of the maze**
 - Change the walls
 - Make a way to add time
 - Make a cheat code
 - Need to outline things more clearly because you don't know what to do
 - Need to outline things more clearly because you don't
 - Move to start, make the text bigger
-
- Shift around with the text, better text
 - Very RNG based, feels like you win you win and if you lose you lose fr
 - A little confusing and a little hard to understand how to play the game
 - A little confusing and a little hard to understand how to play the game
 - Maybe do a zoom out, to let people know where they are
 - Show where the exit is
 - Zoom out to show where the exit is and where the direction is
 - An arrow to show where to go
 - Powers for each one, ones fast, ones less stress, ones tuff
 - Once you finish the maze for one of them you unlock a new character
 - Bottom right arrow
 - 'What'

- Timer bigger
- Make instructions more clear
- What are the boxes
- Default circle bigger maybe
- 1 second to spare
- Field of vision narrowing.
- **Game mechanic suggestion - zoom out makes anxiety or button to make the walls a bit bigger or some sort of power up**
- **Feels like an episode but its helping you reduce stress**
- **Wall width.**
- Make the red zone bigger and make it a circle radius
- Hard to see text
- Add increasing difficulties
- Two of them are locked
- Make the timer larger

Goal: To make the users feel dizzy and confused, unable to control themselves.
UNPREDICATBLE.

You are on a journey but you are terrified of what's to come, you repeatedly get stressed by many things along the way. Hopefully you don't completely lose control before reaching your destination otherwise things will get dangerous!

Game Concept

The concept of the game is...

The user is given a character that they can control with their computer keys. The user is put inside a maze that is easy to navigate but then suddenly, everything goes dark. The user must get to the end of the maze while taking into account that there is a stress meter at the bottom of their screen. This screen indicates the level of the character's stress. The character's stress goes up and down randomly, but also depending on the situation and it is the user's job to reach the end of the maze in time. Reaching a full stress meter slows down the user's progress so it's their job to work around the causes of stress to reach the end.

Core Mechanics

Mechanic 1: Maze Navigation → Arrow keys are able to move the player around, the screen also follows the player centered to ensure visibility. The player can only see around them with a mid-sized circle of light. The maze is larger than the screen, with the POV following the player around. As stress increases, the visible radius starts to shrink.

Mechanic 2: Stress Meter → There will be a visible bar on say the bottom or top of the screen, as time progresses so does the stress meter (taking too long gets stressful). The stress meter fills faster when players: 1. run to try and reach the end faster 2. Go into narrow zones 3. Goes into "scarier zones". On the other hand, the stress meter drops slowly when standing still and in calm zones.

Mechanic 3: Episode State → When stress hits 100% the player gets put into an episode-like state. The player's movement becomes delayed and controls become inverted to emit confusion. The visibility on the screen also shrinks and shakes while sound becomes muffled for a period of time.

To get out of this state, the player can either: 1. Stop moving and wait out the time which is 3-5 seconds, or reach a calm zone.

Mechanic 4: Calm Zones → Specific areas where stress drains and vision clears, this is to help you not end up maxing the stress meter and reaching the episode state. These areas will look softer and warmer visually. There are not many areas like these around the maze but they can be beneficial or not depending on the situation the player is in.

Mechanic 5: Micro-Spike Events → Random stress spikes will occur to really emphasize that unpredictable feeling of having epilepsy. This consists of random vision blurs, jitters in movement, and even sudden mini stress spikes. These random events will not happen constantly so that it doesn't genuinely disrupt a player's progress.

(Display a timer of 90 seconds in a certain spot of the screen)

How do they Win? Reach the end of the maze in time

How do they lose? By not reaching the end of the maze in time

Game states

Player Controls

- Arrow keys/WASD → control the character
- Enter → start game
- Left and right keys to choose character
- P = pause game
- R = restart game
- (idea) mouse click to get stressful images off of screen? (just an idea no need to implement)

Visual Style

- Keep it pretty simple for now, need to get the mechanics down before starting to make it look aesthetic
- Make it a maze that starts grey and goes darker and darker.
- Kinda feels like a horror game but only during the epilepsy recreation part. The other time while the user is playing the game, everything feels normal. Everything changes so sudden which really replicates the idea of epilepsy.
- There is a mid-sized circle of visibility around the character to set a scarier mood and make it harder to find your way through the maze.

***After testing if its too hard we can add time bonuses around the map.**

Entry Header

Name: Hoy

Role(s): Gameplay Systems Developer, Artstyle Director, Research Alignment

Primary responsibility for this work:

Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game, Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics, Created ideas for Gemini to create reference assets where Claude added into the game. Helped with research about epilepsy

Goal of Work Session

Briefly describe what you were trying to accomplish during this phase of the assignment.

- Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game.
- Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics through play testing
- Created ideas for Gemini to create reference assets that Claude added into the game.
- Helped with research about epilepsy

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Gemini
- Google

Entry Header

Name: Jayden

Role(s): Prompt Engineer, Gameplay Systems Developer, Research Alignment

Primary responsibility for this work:

Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game, Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics. Compiled and pushed code to github using VS Studio

Goal of Work Session

Briefly describe what you were trying to accomplish during this phase of the assignment.

- Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game.
- Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics through play testing

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Google
- Claude
- VS Studio
- Github Desktop

Entry Header

Name: Noah

Role(s): Project Manager, Research Analysis, Game conceptualized

Primary responsibility for this work:

Understanding what epilepsy is and how to make a game that helps to show people this experience. Manage everyone and make sure work is being done on time. Came up with good mechanics for the game to work and look good.

Goal of Work Session

Briefly describe what you were trying to accomplish during this phase of the assignment.

- Conducted Research of epilepsy
- Managed everyone and the timeline to make sure everything stays on track
- Make sure the segments are done before moving on
- Come up with cool description to introduce our project.

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Doc
- Timeline
- Charter

Entry Header

Name: Tabish

Role(s): Research Analysis, Game conceptualized, Prompt Engineering

Primary responsibility for this work:

Understanding what epilepsy is and how to make a game that helps to show people this experience. Manage everyone and make sure work is being done on time. Came up with good mechanics for the game to work and look good. Created prompts to be used with Claude.

Goal of Work Session

Briefly describe what you were trying to accomplish during this phase of the assignment.

- Conducted Research of epilepsy
- Managed everyone and the timeline to make sure everything stays on track
- Make sure the segments are done before moving on
- Prompt engineering

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Doc
- Timeline
- Charter

Entry Header

Name: Daniel

Role(s): Research Alignment, Tester

Primary responsibility for this work:

Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game, Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics. Help test gameplay mechanics right after every prompt execution.

Goal of Work Session

Briefly describe what you were trying to accomplish during this phase of the assignment.

- Help with prompting in Claude Code to create the game.
- Thought/Refined ideas for game mechanics
- Help test gameplay mechanics right after every prompt execution
- Recording feedback from users

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Gemini
- Google

GenAI Documentation

If GenAI was used (keep each response as brief as possible):

Date Used: March 2 - March 11, 2026

Tool Disclosure: Claude Opus 4.6

Purpose of Use:

- Coding our game
- Debugging
- Summarization
- Wording support

Summary of Interaction:

- Developed our core mechanics
- Generated sound effects, character design, background, wall texture, controls, how to play tutorial

Human Decision Point(s):

- Used all prompts in some way for the final game because they were accurate for what we wanted the game to have
- Enlarged text size since users were not able to see the text in previous testing
- Added new wall texture, characters, and background layout for improved design
- Modified game features such as, addition orbs, zoom out feature, and arrow to make it easier for players

Integrity & Verification Note:

- Tested the game to make sure core functions are accurate after every prompt was executed

Scope of GenAI Use:

- Brainstorming of our final game
- Recording feedback notes
- Developing the README file
- Writing our prompts

Limitations or Misfires:

- Our GenAI tool was very accurate for every prompt we executed

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)

Describe what you did, focusing on process rather than outcome. This may include:

- Added new design changes such as background, wall textures, and characters to make the game more appealing
- Added Orbs that add 5 seconds to the timer to make the game more easier since players during testing had difficulty reaching the checkpoint in time
- Added different mechanics for each player to add different levels of difficulty to make to game more unique
- Discussed how we could implement the images into the GenAI tool
- Tested every prompt that was executed in the GenAI tool to make sure every function was working

Decision Points & Trade-offs

Describe one or two key decisions you made:

- Adding time boosts and Z for zoom out to make the game a little more beginner friendly
 - We also considered adding more time instead of time boosts
- We thought adding more time would be too easy for players because of multiple reasons. Based on RNG players can already win or lose really quickly depending on if there are many calm zones and an easy path to the end. Adding an extra 30 seconds or even 15 would likely guarantee a win every time.

These decisions should align with decision points shown in your visualization (for A1 – A3).

Verification & Judgement

Explain how you evaluated whether your decision or change was appropriate:

- After we added the new mechanics, we went into testing once again to examine the new win/loss percentages of our game
 - Our testers (Hoy and Tabish) explained that winning with the newly added time boosts and zoom feature seemed more plausible when it came to unlucky RNG generated mazes.

- It also became even clearer after our final in class tester won the game not long after learning how to play for the first time.
 - This was a drastic difference from our showcase tester from the week before as their win percentage was less than 10% (only one win after more than 10 attempts)

Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions

- When in episode state, the character is supposed to have inverted controls and the screen shakes violently. This state is supposed to last 5 seconds but no matter how many times we told Claude to fix it, it stayed the same. We finally fixed the mechanic near the end of our timeline but the text telling players to stop moving to cancel the state remained.

Appendix

Claude Transcript:

We inputted a pdf of the transcript in the VS code / Github.

Sprite:

<https://gemini.google.com/share/c911a261f254>